



A Better Recess Corner: Opinion Letter Workshop

Grade 3 • Michigan • Writing

W.3.1

Write an opinion with organized reasons, linking language, and a conclusion. Includes 16 practice tasks, a four-task exit check, two explained models, and complete answer guidance.

PRINT • TEACH • REVISIT



Plan a focused lesson

Level and alignment

Grade 3 • Michigan • Writing; W.3.1. Focus: Write an opinion with organized reasons, linking language, and a conclusion.

What is included

One cover; one teacher guide; one mini-lesson with two explained models; 1 original text/reference section(s); 16 practice tasks on four pages; one four-task exit check; four answer-key pages covering all 20 tasks; two access/source/license pages. Student texts are original, not extracted from released tests.

Time and sequence

Two 30–40-minute sessions plus a 10–15-minute exit check; extended writing or speech rehearsal may take longer. Model first; use tasks 1–4 to check readiness; practice the remainder in short groups; give tasks 17–20 without the key.

Preparation

Print student pages separately from teacher pages. Provide pencils and extra paper; oral-response learners need an adult recorder. Review word meanings and prerequisite decoding or sentence skills. No paid app, novel, or external reading is required.

Student directions

Read the lesson and supplied text or reference. Attempt each task before viewing the key. Explain when asked. Use separate paper for full drafts or longer answers; the PDF is not a fillable form.

Learn the move

An opinion states what you think should happen. Reasons explain why. Introduce the topic, state one clear opinion, group useful reasons, connect them with because/also/therefore, and end by returning to your opinion. Use the fictional planning notes without claiming they describe your own school.

Model 1 • Improve “The corner.” into an opinion.

Our class should create a quiet reading corner for recess. It names the topic and a position.

Model 2 • Connect: It gives another activity. Some students prefer quiet play.

We should offer a reading corner because some students prefer quiet play. The reason supports the opinion.

Try the task first. Then compare the reasoning, not just the final word.



Fictional planning notes

Pine Class may choose one indoor recess corner: a puzzle table or a drawing table. Both fit four children. The puzzle table has six reusable puzzles. Its pieces need counting after use. The drawing table has scrap paper and shared pencils. Children can display finished drawings. Both spaces need a cleanup routine. These are invented classroom facts for this writing exercise.



Practice • Read, reason, respond

Read the lesson and supplied text or reference. Attempt each task before viewing the key. Explain when asked. Use separate paper for full drafts or longer answers; the PDF is not a fillable form.

1. Name the decision Pine Class must make.

2. Write your opinion in a complete sentence.

3. Give one reason for your choice.

4. Give a second, different reason.



Practice • Read, reason, respond

Read the lesson and supplied text or reference. Attempt each task before viewing the key. Explain when asked. Use separate paper for full drafts or longer answers; the PDF is not a fillable form.

5. Which is more useful: “I like it” or a detail about what children can do? Why?

6. Write an opening naming the topic and opinion.

7. Use because to connect one reason to your opinion.

8. Use also to add the second reason.



Practice • Read, reason, respond

Read the lesson and supplied text or reference. Attempt each task before viewing the key. Explain when asked. Use separate paper for full drafts or longer answers; the PDF is not a fillable form.

9. Identify one cleanup need for your choice.

10. Explain how a cleanup routine could address that need.

11. Write a conclusion returning to your opinion.

12. Should your conclusion suddenly ask for a pet? Explain.



Practice • Read, reason, respond

Read the lesson and supplied text or reference. Attempt each task before viewing the key. Explain when asked. Use separate paper for full drafts or longer answers; the PDF is not a fillable form.

13. Plan the order: reasons, conclusion, opening.

14. Draft a 5–7-sentence letter using your work.

15. Underline a linking word in your letter and explain its job.

16. Revise one vague sentence to be more specific.



Exit check • Apply the skill

Try without the answer key. Show evidence or reasoning when asked. Use separate paper for longer responses.

17. New choice: a class read-aloud or a class drawing time. State an opinion.

18. Give two reasons that support it.

19. Connect your reasons using a linking word or phrase.

20. Write a short concluding sentence.



Answers and response criteria

1. Choose a puzzle table or a drawing table.
2. Either choice is acceptable if clearly stated.
3. Example: Drawing lets children create pictures; or puzzles can be used repeatedly.
4. Example: Drawing displays let children share art; puzzles provide six choices. Must be distinct and supported.
5. A specific activity detail explains a benefit; “I like it” repeats preference without explaining.

Accept equivalent correct answers and well-supported interpretations. Sample writing is guidance, not a required script.



Answers and response criteria

6. Example: For indoor recess, Pine Class should add a drawing table.
7. Complete sentence with a logically relevant reason.
8. Sentence adds a genuinely different benefit.
9. Puzzle pieces need counting; shared drawing supplies need gathering. Accept reasonable inference labeled as a plan.
10. Example: Assign a piece checker or a pencil collector; explain the connection.

Accept equivalent correct answers and well-supported interpretations. Sample writing is guidance, not a required script.



Answers and response criteria

11. Example: For these reasons, a puzzle table would be a useful recess choice.
12. No; that is a new topic not supported by the letter's reasons.
13. Opening, reasons, conclusion.
14. Require topic/opinion, two relevant reasons, linking language, and conclusion. Either choice may earn full credit.
15. Because connects a reason; also adds support; therefore signals a conclusion.

Accept equivalent correct answers and well-supported interpretations. Sample writing is guidance, not a required script.



Answers and response criteria

16. Example: “It is fun” → “Six puzzles give the group several choices.” Require an observable improvement.

17. Either clear preference with the topic stated.

18. Require two relevant, different reasons; personal experience may be identified as personal.

19. Meaningful because, also, since, or for example; sentence remains coherent.

20. Returns to the stated choice without introducing an unrelated demand.

Accept equivalent correct answers and well-supported interpretations. Sample writing is guidance, not a required script.



Access and next teaching steps

AIG

Ask for a counterexample, an alternative supported interpretation, or a newly written item with an explanation. Add depth rather than speed.

504

Follow the individual plan: breaks, enlarged print, extra time, reduced copying, or an alternative response method as documented. These are classroom options, not a statement of permitted test accommodations.

EC

Follow the IEP; show one task at a time, model the first decision, and permit dictated reasoning when appropriate. For decoding practice, distinguish an adult-read direction from an adult-read target word.

ESL

Preview task verbs and key vocabulary, allow home-language planning, and offer “My answer is ___ because ___.” Evaluate the targeted skill separately from unrelated language errors. For French, retain the target French sentence while explaining directions in a familiar language.

Use the exit evidence

For each exit task, record 2 = accurate and complete for the stated prompt; 1 = partly accurate or missing a requested explanation; 0 = not yet demonstrated. Total 0–8 is a local teaching note, not a standardized score. For oral tasks do not penalize spelling or handwriting. Revisit the exact type of error rather than assigning a diagnostic label.

Next lesson: model one missed decision, let the learner try a new example, and compare the explanation. Extend only after the learner can explain the targeted skill.

Alignment, sources, and license

The objective is original wording describing a focused part of the cited standard; this is not a full curriculum or official practice test.

Official state standard • accessed September 15, 2026

https://www.michigan.gov/-/media/Project/Websites/mde/Literacy/Content-Standards/ELA_Standards.pdf

Research limit: official released-assessment retrieval was unsuccessful in this run. This packet is standards-focused classroom instruction; it makes no released-test alignment, timing, or scoring claim.

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